

Palestine – Conflict

LTC Situation Report (Telecoms Area) #69

Reporting period: May 2026

The WFP-led Logistics and Telecommunications Cluster (LTC) was activated as the Emergency Telecommunications Cluster (ETC) on 31 October 2023 in response to the crisis in Gaza. This Situation Report provides a monthly update on LTC telecoms activities. All references to the LTC in this report relate specifically to the telecommunications area of the cluster.

Summary Points

- LTC Telecoms in Palestine continues to adapt its response in Gaza to sustain critical communications for humanitarian operations in a highly constrained environment, with a focus on expanding secure connectivity, maintaining power and network functionality, and advocating for the entry of fuel, spare parts, and essential technical equipment.
- On 06 May, LTC Telecoms and its lead agency, WFP, met with the Humanitarian Military Interaction Access Unit (HMI) to review the import status of ICT equipment and recent changes to approval processes required by the authorities, which WFP will formally communicate to stakeholders.
- In May, LTC Telecoms established a two-year Long-Term Agreement (LTA) with Track24, covering 07 May 2026 to 06 May 2028, to support satellite-based tracking of personnel and vehicles, and shared it with UNDSS for dissemination to UN agencies.



LTC delivers security comms training for humanitarian staff on 17 May at Khan Younis Training College. Photo: UNRWA/Saeda Abu Alroos.

Humanitarian Overview

Humanitarian conditions in Gaza remained extreme and life-threatening throughout May, with most of the population displaced and living in overcrowded, inadequate shelters amid ongoing insecurity and intermittent hostilities.

Humanitarian operations were severely constrained by access restrictions, insecurity, limited entry points, and shortages of fuel, spare parts, and critical supplies, resulting in inconsistent aid delivery and increasing risks to essential infrastructure systems. Kerem Shalom remained the only operational crossing for humanitarian cargo, with Zikim partially reopened for northern entry, while all other crossings, including Rafah and Kissufim, remained closed.

Despite sustained humanitarian efforts, significant funding gaps, access limitations, and widespread infrastructure damage prevented the scale-up of assistance, leaving conditions deteriorating with no immediate prospect of recovery.

Telecommunications Overview

Telecommunications services in Gaza remain critically disrupted due to extensive infrastructure damage, ongoing hostilities, and severely limited access for repairs. An estimated 75 percent of network infrastructure has been destroyed since October 2023.

Mobile data services remain unavailable, with only intermittent 2G voice coverage in limited areas. Many sites rely on overstretched generators, increasing the risk of permanent equipment failure and a potential full communications blackout without urgent entry of spare parts and consumables.

Damage to fibre backbones and microwave links has forced operators to rely on short-range, improvised solutions with limited reliability. The use of Starlink devices remains prohibited under national regulations and due to lack of authorised coverage.

Humanitarian operations continue to depend on a small quantity of satellite phones, VHF radio, and in-person coordination, while operators face persistent equipment shortages and movement restrictions. Communities rely on private generators, informal charging points, and improvised Wi-Fi hotspots where minimal connectivity is available.

LTC Activities

Coordination

In May, LTC Telecoms in Palestine continued to adapt its response in Gaza to sustain critical communications for humanitarian operations under highly constrained conditions. Priorities remained focused on expanding secure connectivity, maintaining power and network functionality, and advocating for the entry of fuel, spare parts, and essential ICT equipment to ensure continuity of services.

Engagements during May focused on strengthening coordination and advocacy. LTC Telecoms engaged with private sector telecommunications actors to support connectivity solutions, cluster-related activities, and contingency planning for the West Bank. Discussions with the Association of International Development Agencies (AIDA) further addressed constraints on equipment entry into Gaza, with follow-up planned to support engagement with relevant authorities.

On 06 May, LTC Telecoms and WFP met with the Humanitarian Military Interaction Access Unit (HMI) to review import procedures for ICT equipment and related approval requirements. Updates on the approval process were shared and are being formalized by WFP, while follow-up continues on pending approvals.

On 07 May, LTC Telecoms and WFP conducted a site assessment of the UNDP building in Gaza City to support plans for re-establishing inter-agency presence in northern Gaza. While the structure was assessed as suitable, significant enabling works are required, including cabling, electrical preparation, and ICT installation, with follow-up actions underway.

LTC Telecoms also participated in the Education Cluster sub-national meeting on 07 May to present on telecoms activities and challenges, with further technical discussions planned. Additional coordination on 10 May included engagement with private sector operators on connectivity and contingency planning, alongside the completion of fuel repayments to telecommunications actors through in-kind arrangements with UNOPS and WFP.

Internet connectivity

Humanitarian operations in Gaza remained critically dependent on Paltel as the sole functioning Internet Service Provider (ISP), with no alternative or backup systems such as fibre, microwave links, or VSAT available, leaving agencies without redundancy to mitigate disruptions.

In May, LTC Telecoms engaged Jawwal/Paltel to address connectivity challenges, operational requirements, and options to reduce connectivity costs for humanitarian hubs, with follow-up actions planned.

LTC Telecoms also strengthened connectivity at the Palestinian Non-Governmental Organization (PNGO) Gaza City location by refurbishing and configuring a donated computer as a dedicated security and user management appliance. Training for the PNGO IT Manager on system commissioning, maintenance, backup, and recovery is planned, supported by detailed documentation.

Security Communications Systems

LTC Telecoms and partners continued advancing the 2026–27 interagency Security Communications Plan by consolidating VHF repeater data, integrating recent assessments, and supporting the standardisation of UN radio configurations. With the risk of a full internet outage, strengthening radio communications as a reliable fallback remained a priority, alongside UNDSS requests for agencies to submit full radio inventories for inclusion in the master plan. Proof-of-concept testing of the recently upgraded digital system is underway following discussions with UNDSS on 07 May.

LTC Telecoms coordinated with the Palestine Red Crescent Society and the International Committee of the Red Cross to support repairs to the VHF network.

On 13 May, a VHF coverage assessment along the Gaza City–Zikim convoy route was completed, with recommendations issued to improve signal coverage and reliability.

A two-year Long-Term Agreement (LTA) with Track24, a satellite-based provider of vehicle and personnel tracking services, was established for the period 07 May 2026 to 06 May 2028 to support real-time tracking inside the Gaza Strip, enhancing operational safety.

Between 17 and 18 May, LTC Telecoms configured service laptops for VHF equipment and humanitarian hub operations, while also providing technical guidance to support site configuration in North Gaza. Additional SCS training was delivered in Khan Younis on 17 May, including sessions in Arabic, to strengthen frontline capacity to maintain critical communications.

Further Information

Visit the [LTC Dashboard](#) for an overview of planned and active services.

Funding

LTC Telecoms requires USD 1 million to sustain critical telecommunications, coordination, and information management services in Gaza, in line with the [2026 Flash Appeal](#) for the occupied Palestinian territory.

On 12 May, LTC Telecoms submitted a concept note to WFP Partnerships to explore additional funding options for ongoing activities in Gaza.

Challenges

Fuel Shortages: Inconsistent fuel supply, compounded by ongoing regional escalation, is hindering humanitarian operations including telecommunications services.

Limited telecommunications services: Voice and internet services in Gaza remain limited due to widespread infrastructure damage, limited access, import restrictions, and a lack of repair equipment.

Lack of telecommunications equipment: Hostilities have destroyed key equipment, and ongoing import restrictions severely limit LTC's ability to restore and deliver its planned services.

Staff safety: Volatile security conditions and movement restrictions continue to compromise the safety and security of humanitarian staff and hinder the deployment of LTC services.

Cybersecurity risks: Cybersecurity threats remain high. Use of tech platforms, including social and press media, requires caution.

Funding: Limited funding continues to constrain LTC's ability to meet urgent communications needs.

Meetings

The next Global LTC Teleconference on telecoms for the Gaza response will take place on **Tuesday 16 June 2026** at 13:00 UTC. All meeting minutes are available [here](#).

Contacts

NAME	POSITION	LOCATION	CONTACT
Shantal Boodhun	LTC Telecoms Coordinator	Gaza (Deir al Balah)	shantal.boodhun@wfp.org
David Pickering	LTC Telecoms Field Coordinator	Gaza (Deir Al Balah)	david.pickering@wfp.org
Mufaro Masuka	Global LTC Telecoms Information Management	Remote	mufaro.masuka@wfp.org

Further information related to the LTC Palestine (telecoms) operation can be found on the website:

www.etcluster.org/emergency/palestine-conflict

For more information or to be added or deleted from the mailing list, please contact:

Palestine.ETC@wfp.org